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Introduction

Phase 2 of the project moves from planning to implementation. The earlier phase defined the problem: support teams need a single place to log customer issues, track their priority and status, and spot tickets at risk of breaching a service-level agreement (SLA). Phase 2 builds the **backend** of that solution on the Salesforce platform, which means the data model and the configuration that make the application usable.

Salesforce is a cloud-based Customer Relationship Management (CRM) platform delivered under the Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) and Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) models. Everything in it can be built with point-and-click configuration and extended with Apex code where needed.

Objectives of this phase

- Create a Salesforce Developer account to obtain a free, full-featured development environment.
- Activate the account, set a secure password and a security question, and explore the Setup Home page.
- Design and create the custom object **Support Ticket Intelligence** together with its fields.
- Create a custom tab so that users can open the object directly from the navigation bar.
- Verify the configuration by viewing a sample record (TKT-0001) and by querying the data through Agentforce.

Summary of components built

Component	Purpose
Developer Org	The Salesforce environment in which all configuration is performed
Custom Object	Support Ticket Intelligence: stores each support ticket as a record
Custom Fields	Ticket Number, Customer, Issue Type, Priority Level, Status, SLA Breach Risk, Resolution Time and others
Custom Tab	Gives users one-click access to the object's list and records

1. Salesforce Account

1.1 Theory: the Salesforce platform and Developer Edition

Salesforce runs on a **multi-tenant** architecture. Many customers (called *orgs*) share the same infrastructure, but each org's data and configuration are logically isolated from the others. Because the vendor manages servers, upgrades and security patches, the developer only needs a web browser. Releases arrive automatically three times a year.

An **org** is a single instance of Salesforce with its own users, data, objects and settings. Organizations typically keep several: a production org for live users, *sandboxes* for testing, and Developer orgs for learning and prototyping. A **Developer Edition** org is free and contains most platform features, including custom objects, Flow automation, Apex, Lightning App Builder and APIs. It is meant for building and learning, not for running live business data.

Feature	Developer Edition
Cost	Free, no credit card required
Purpose	Learning, prototyping, and testing applications
Customization	Custom objects, fields, tabs, apps, validation rules, Flows, Apex, Lightning components
Users	Limited number of full licenses (suited to a single developer)
Data storage	Limited storage, adequate for development and demonstrations

1.2 Step 1: Signing up for a Developer account

The account is created from the Salesforce Developer sign-up page. The form asks for the details below; a valid email address matters most, because the activation link is sent there.

- 1 Open the Salesforce Developer Edition sign-up page in a browser.
- 2 Enter **First Name**, **Last Name**, **Email**, **Role** and **Company**.
- 3 Provide the remaining fields (country, postal code and a unique **Username** in email format, e.g. name@company.dev). The username must be unique across all of Salesforce, but it need not be a real mailbox.
- 4 Accept the Master Subscription Agreement and click **Sign me up**.

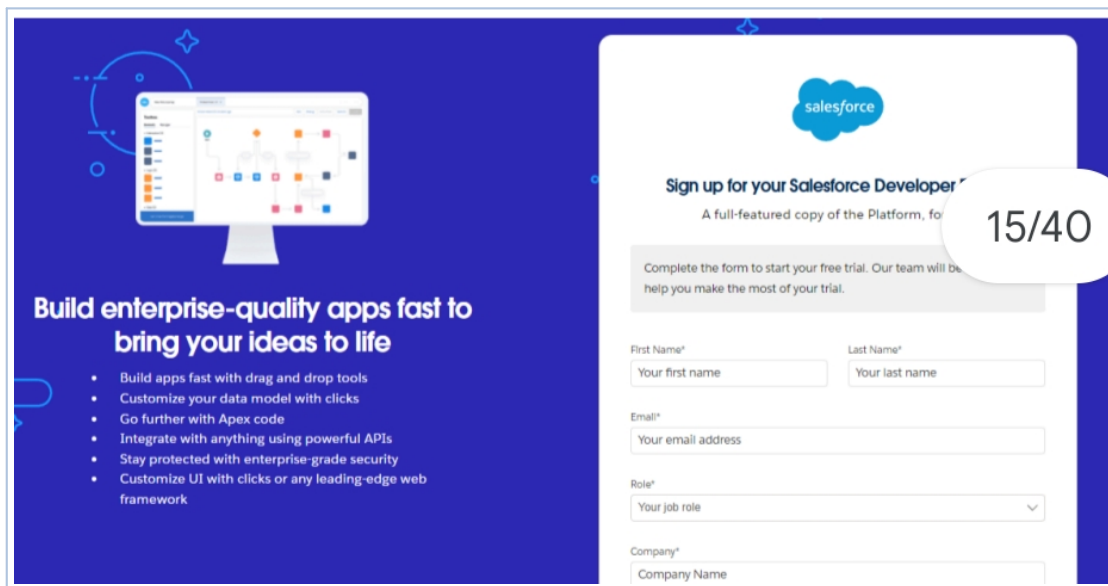
The image shows the Salesforce Developer Edition sign-up form. On the left, a blue banner with a white monitor icon displays the text "Build enterprise-quality apps fast to bring your ideas to life" and a bulleted list of features: "Build apps fast with drag and drop tools", "Customize your data model with clicks", "Go further with Apex code", "Integrate with anything using powerful APIs", "Stay protected with enterprise-grade security", and "Customize UI with clicks or any leading-edge web framework". On the right, the form is white with the Salesforce logo at the top. It includes the heading "Sign up for your Salesforce Developer Edition", a subtext "A full-featured copy of the Platform, for free", and a note "Complete the form to start your free trial. Our team will be happy to help you make the most of your trial." The form fields are: "First Name*" (with placeholder "Your first name"), "Last Name*" (with placeholder "Your last name"), "Email*" (with placeholder "Your email address"), "Role*" (a dropdown menu with "Your job role" selected), and "Company*" (with placeholder "Company Name"). A white speech bubble with the text "15/40" is overlaid on the right side of the form.

Figure 1.1: Salesforce Developer Edition sign-up form

The page lists the benefits of the platform: building apps quickly with drag-and-drop tools, customizing the data model with clicks, going further with Apex code, integrating through APIs, enterprise-grade security, and customizing the UI with clicks or a web framework. These are the capabilities used throughout this project.

1.3 Step 2: Account activation and password setup

After the form is submitted, Salesforce sends a verification email. Clicking **Verify Account** in that email opens the **Change Your Password** page, where the account is secured for the first time.

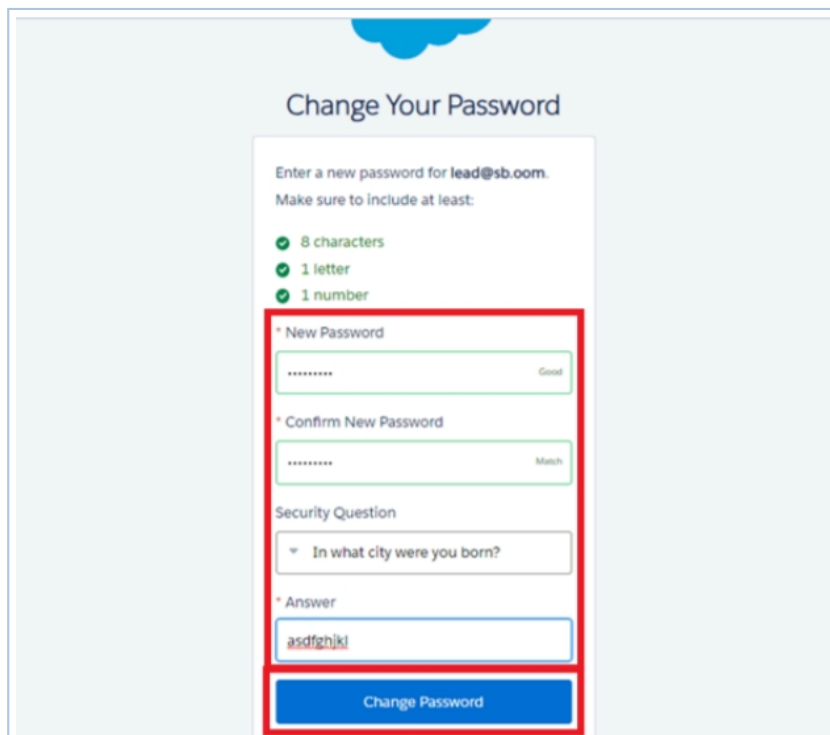
The image shows the "Change Your Password" page. At the top, it says "Change Your Password" with the Salesforce logo. Below that, it says "Enter a new password for lead@sb.com. Make sure to include at least:" followed by three green checkmarks and requirements: "8 characters", "1 letter", and "1 number". The form fields are: "New Password" (with a "Good" strength indicator), "Confirm New Password" (with a "Match" strength indicator), "Security Question" (a dropdown menu with "In what city were you born?" selected), and "Answer" (with the text "asdfghjkl" entered). A blue "Change Password" button is at the bottom. A red rectangular box highlights the "New Password", "Confirm New Password", "Security Question", "Answer", and "Change Password" button fields.

Figure 1.2: Change Your Password page (new password, confirmation and security question)

As Figure 1.2 shows, the page enforces a minimum password policy. Each requirement turns green once it is met:

- at least **8 characters**;
- at least **1 letter**;
- at least **1 number**.

The form has four inputs to complete:

Field	Description
New Password	The password for the account. The strength indicator shows <i>Good</i> when the policy is satisfied.
Confirm New Password	The same password re-entered; the indicator shows <i>Match</i> when both entries agree.
Security Question	A question (for example, <i>In what city were you born?</i>) used to verify identity during account recovery.
Answer	The answer to the chosen security question. It should be memorable but not guessable.

Clicking **Change Password** completes activation and signs the user in. Credentials should be stored in a password manager, and the Developer org should be treated as a personal workspace.

Good practice: use a unique password for the Salesforce account, and keep the username and login URL in the project notes. Enabling Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) is recommended; Salesforce provides the *Multi-Factor Authentication Assistant* in Setup.

1.4 Step 3: Exploring the Setup Home page

Once logged in, the user lands in the Lightning Experience interface. All administration and configuration happens in **Setup**, opened from the gear icon in the top bar. The first screen is **Setup Home**.

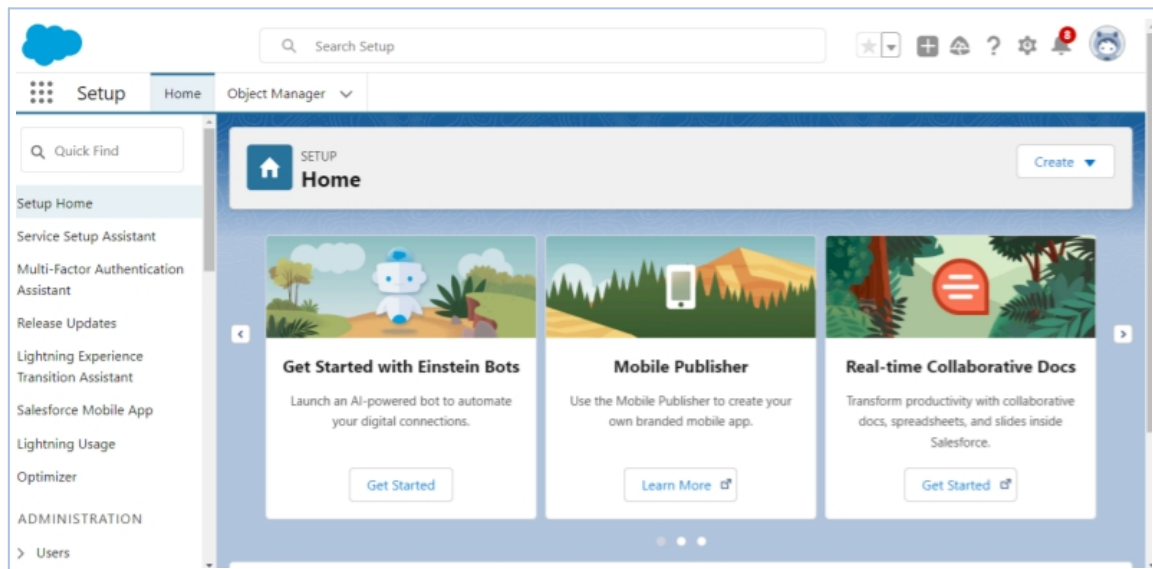


Figure 1.3: Salesforce Setup Home page

Key elements visible in Figure 1.3

Element	Explanation
Search Setup	Global search box at the top for finding any setup page, object or setting by name.
App Launcher (grid icon)	Opens the list of apps and tabs available in the org.
Setup Home / Object Manager	The two main tabs. Object Manager is where objects and their fields, layouts and relationships are defined.
Quick Find	Search box in the left menu that filters the Setup navigation tree (for example, typing <i>Tabs</i>).
Left navigation	Categories such as Administration (Users), Platform Tools, Environments and Settings.
Feature cards	Shortcuts such as Einstein Bots, Mobile Publisher and Real-time Collaborative Docs.
Top-right utilities	Favorites, Guidance Center, Help, Setup gear, Notifications and the profile avatar.

Understanding this layout is important because the next two sections, creating the object and creating the tab, are both performed from here. Object definitions live under **Object Manager**, while tabs are created from **User Interface > Tabs** in Setup.

1.5 Outcome of Section 1

At the end of this section the project has a working Salesforce Developer org, an activated and secured user account, and a clear understanding of where configuration tasks are carried out. This is the foundation for building the data model.

2. Objects Creation

2.1 Theory: objects, fields and records

In Salesforce, data is stored in **objects**, which are comparable to tables in a relational database. An object is made up of **fields** (columns) and each row of data is a **record**. A well-designed object represents a single business concept; for this project, that concept is the customer support ticket.

Database concept	Salesforce term	Example in this project
Table	Object	Support Ticket Intelligence
Column	Field	Priority Level, Status, SLA Breach Risk
Row	Record	TKT-0001
Foreign key	Lookup / Master-Detail relationship	Customer (links to an Account)

Standard objects and custom objects

Standard objects such as Account, Contact, Lead, Opportunity and Case come with Salesforce. **Custom objects** are created by the administrator for data the standard model does not cover; the API name of every custom object ends in __c. Here a custom object named **Support Ticket Intelligence** is created to add SLA-risk and resolution-time tracking to ordinary ticket data.

Common field types

Field type	Use
Auto Number	System-generated unique identifier with a format, such as TKT-{0000}.
Text / Text Area	Free-text values such as short descriptions.
Picklist	A fixed list of choices, e.g. Priority: Low, Medium, High.
Lookup Relationship	A link to another record such as an Account, Contact or User.
Date / Date-Time	Calendar values such as the created date.
Checkbox	True or false value, e.g. SLA Breach Risk.
Number	Numeric values such as resolution time in hours.

2.2 Steps to create the custom object

- 1 Click the **Setup gear icon** and choose **Setup**, then open the **Object Manager** tab.
- 2 Click **Create > Custom Object**.
- 3 Enter the **Label** as *Support Ticket Intelligence*; the plural label and the API name (Support_Ticket_Intelligence__c) are filled automatically.

- 4 Set the **Record Name** to *Ticket Number* and the **Data Type** to *Auto Number*, with a display format of TKT - {0000} and a starting number of 1. The records then appear as TKT-0001, TKT-0002 and so on.
- 5 Under Optional Features, enable **Allow Reports**, **Allow Activities**, **Track Field History** and **Allow Search**, so that the object can be reported on and found through global search.
- 6 Under Deployment Status choose **Deployed** so that users can see it, then click **Save**.
- 7 Open **Fields & Relationships > New** and create each custom field from the field list below, choosing the data type, label, values and field-level security.

2.3 Fields of the Support Ticket Intelligence object

The record detail page in Figure 2.1 shows the fields configured on the object. Their purpose is summarized below.

Field label	Type	Purpose
Ticket Number	Auto Number	Unique ID of the ticket (e.g. TKT-0001); acts as the record name.
Customer	Lookup (Account)	The customer organization raising the ticket, e.g. Edge Communications.
Contact	Lookup (Contact)	The person at the customer who reported the issue.
Issue Type	Picklist	Category of the problem, e.g. Technical.
Description	Text	Details of the issue, e.g. 'urgent'.
Priority Level	Picklist	Importance of the ticket, e.g. Low.
Status	Picklist	Stage of the ticket, e.g. New.
Assigned To	Lookup (User)	The support engineer responsible for the ticket.
Created Date	Date	Date the ticket was raised.
SLA Breach Risk	Checkbox	Flags tickets in danger of breaching the SLA.
Resolution Time (hrs)	Number	Time taken or expected to resolve the ticket, in hours.
Owner	Standard field	User who owns the record.
Created By / Last Modified By	System fields	Audit fields that record who created or changed the record, and when.

2.4 Verifying the object with a sample record

After the fields were created, a test record was added to confirm that the object works as designed. Figure 2.1 shows the **Details** tab of record **TKT-0001**.

Support Ticket Intelligence
TKT-0001

Related **Details**

Ticket Number	TKT-0001	Owner	Srinath R.
Customer	Edge Communications		
Contact			
Issue Type	Technical		
Description	urgent		
Priority Level	Low		
Status	New		
Assigned To	Srinath R.		
Created Date	10/26/2026		
SLA Breach Risk	✓		
Resolution Time (hrs)	2		
Created By	Srinath R., 10/2/2026, 11:39 PM	Last Modified By	Srinath R., 10/3/2026, 6:33 AM

Figure 2.1: Details tab of record TKT-0001 in the Support Ticket Intelligence object

Reading the record

- **Ticket Number:** TKT-0001, generated automatically by the auto-number field.
- **Customer:** Edge Communications, linked to the Account record as a clickable lookup.
- **Issue Type:** Technical; **Description:** urgent; **Priority Level:** Low; **Status:** New.
- **Assigned To / Owner:** Srinath R.
- **SLA Breach Risk:** checked, so this ticket is flagged as at risk.
- **Resolution Time (hrs):** 2.
- **Created By / Last Modified By:** Srinath R, with date and time stamps maintained automatically by Salesforce.

The pencil icons beside the fields show that the user can edit them inline, and the lookup values are hyperlinks that open the related Account or User record. Because the Related tab is also present, related lists such as notes or activities can be added to the page layout later.

2.5 Querying the object through Agentforce

The object's data can also be accessed in natural language through the **Agentforce** assistant panel. Figure 2.2 shows two requests made against the Support Ticket Intelligence object.

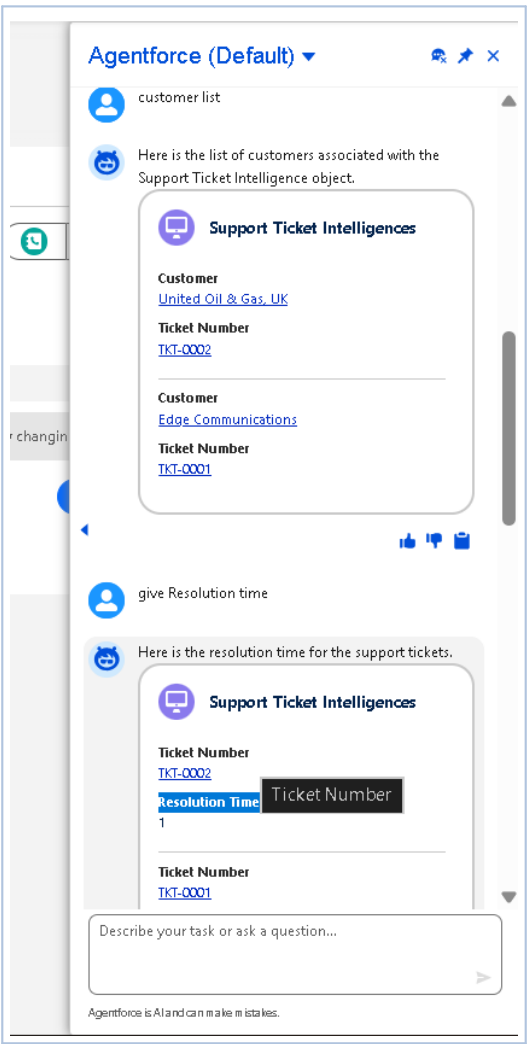


Figure 2.2: Agentforce returning customers and resolution times from the object

Prompt	Result returned
customer list	A card listing the customers associated with the object: United Oil & Gas, UK (TKT-0002) and Edge Communications (TKT-0001).
give Resolution time	A card listing each ticket number with its resolution time, for instance TKT-0002 with a resolution time of 1.

This confirms that the object, its fields and its relationships were created correctly: the assistant can read the Customer, Ticket Number and Resolution Time fields from several records and present them with working links back to each ticket.

3. Creating a Tab for the Support Ticket Intelligence Object

3.1 Theory: tabs in Salesforce

A **tab** is a user-interface element that gives users access to an object's records or to another piece of content from the navigation bar. A newly created custom object has no tab by default, so users would have to reach its records through search or related lists. Creating a tab makes the object discoverable and lets users view lists, open records and create new ones with a single click.

Types of custom tabs

Tab type	Description
Custom Object Tab	Displays the list view and records of a custom object. This is the type used in this project.
Web Tab	Displays an external web page or web application inside Salesforce.
Visualforce Tab	Displays a custom Visualforce page.
Lightning Component Tab	Displays a Lightning component.
Lightning Page Tab	Displays a Lightning page built in the Lightning App Builder.

Tab visibility settings

Setting	Meaning
Default On	The tab is displayed and visible to the profile by default.
Default Off	The tab is available but hidden; users can show it through personalization.
Tab Hidden	The tab is hidden and not available to users with that profile.

A tab also needs a **tab style** (a color and icon). Salesforce offers a large library of icons, so related tabs can share a visual identity, which is visible as the purple monitor icon next to Support Ticket Intelligence in the figures.

3.2 Steps to create the tab

- 1 Open **Setup** and type **Tabs** in the Quick Find box; select **User Interface > Tabs**.
- 2 In the **Custom Object Tabs** section, click **New**.
- 3 From the **Object** dropdown choose **Support Ticket Intelligence**.
- 4 Click the **Tab Style** lookup and select a color and icon (the purple monitor icon is used here).
- 5 Optionally add a short description and a splash page, then click **Next**.
- 6 On the visibility page, choose **Default On** for the required profiles (for example System Administrator), then click **Next**.

- 7 Choose the apps in which the tab should appear (for example the Sales or Service app), and click **Save**.
- 8 Open the **App Launcher**, search for *Support Ticket Intelligence* and confirm that the tab opens the object's list view.

Lightning App Builder alternative: a tab can also be added to an app through **App Manager > Edit > Navigation Items**. This controls which tabs are shown in an app's navigation bar and their order.

3.3 Verifying the tab

Once the tab exists, users can open it, switch between list views, click **New** to log a ticket, and open any record. Opening a ticket shows the page in Figure 3.1, where the Support Ticket Intelligence icon and record name TKT-0001 appear in the page header.

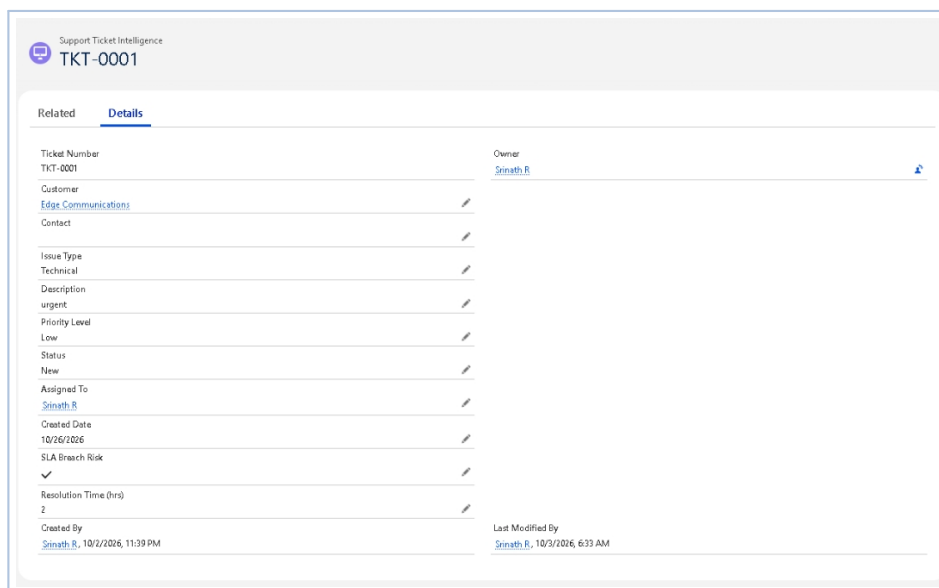


Figure 3.1: Record page of TKT-0001 reached through the Support Ticket Intelligence tab (Details tab)

3.4 Benefits of the tab

- **Fast access:** support agents reach every ticket in one click from the navigation bar.
- **List views:** filtered views such as 'High priority' or 'SLA at risk' can be saved and shared.
- **Consistency:** all users see the same labeled object with the same icon and layout.
- **Control:** profile-based visibility ensures that only the right people see the tab.
- **Foundation for automation:** reports, dashboards and flows can be built on top of the object that the tab exposes.

3.5 Confirming the end-to-end result

The tab, the object and the records come together in the Agentforce conversation. The ticket numbers in the response cards, TKT-0001 and TKT-0002, are links to the record pages that the tab and object expose.

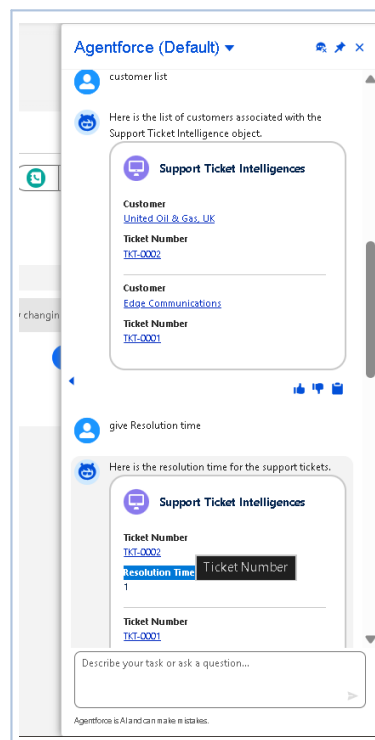


Figure 3.2: Support Ticket Intelligence records presented as linked cards in Agentforce

Summary and Conclusion

Phase 2 delivered the backend foundation of the Support Ticket Intelligence solution. A Salesforce Developer account was created, activated and secured. The custom object **Support Ticket Intelligence** was built with the fields needed to describe a support ticket: customer, issue type, priority, status, assignee, SLA breach risk and resolution time. A custom tab was then created to expose the object in the navigation bar.

Task	Status	Evidence
Salesforce account created and activated	Completed	Figures 1.1 and 1.2
Setup environment explored	Completed	Figure 1.3
Custom object and fields created	Completed	Figure 2.1
Data verified through Agentforce	Completed	Figure 2.2
Custom tab created for the object	Completed	Figures 3.1 and 3.2

The next phase can build on this foundation by adding validation rules, automation (for example a Flow that raises SLA Breach Risk when resolution time is high), page layouts, reports and dashboards.